YIXIAO SUN

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EDUCATION

Michigan State University — East Lansing, MI
Ph.D. in Communication — 2025–
Advisor: David M. Markowitz

Nanjing University — Nanjing, China
M.A. in Communication — 2022–2025
Advisor: Cheng-Jun Wang; GPA: 4.0/4.0

Sichuan International Studies University — Chongqing, China
B.A. in Internet and New Media (Graduated with Highest Distinction) — 2018–2022
Advisor: Hao Liu; GPA: 3.96/4.0

PROFESSIONAL TRAININGS

ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan — Ann Arbor, MI
Coursework in Bayesian modeling, time-series and panel analysis, and quantitative foundations — Summer 2026

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

[5] Markowitz, D. M., & **Sun, Y.** (2026). Language and Persuasion Research: A Computational Literature Review Spanning Five Decades of Scholarship (1974–2025). *Social and Personality Psychology Compass, 20*(9), e70171.

[4] Zhang, Y., **Sun, Y.**, Lu, G., Chen, Z., & Wang, C.-J. (2025). Let Us Not Wallow in the Valley of Despair: The Role of Emotion, Panic, and Sympathy Discourses in Promoting Productive Actions. *International Journal of Business Communication, 63*(4), 1431–1455.

[3] Zhang, Y.†, **Sun, Y.**†, & Wang, C.-J. (2025). Unraveling the Shape of Social Media Narratives: Analyzing the Effects of Online Interaction and Narrative Structure on Attention to Digital Asset Transactions. *Journal of Broadcasting & Electronic Media, 69*(3), 200–218. [**Co-first author**†]

[2] Chen, Z., Yu, W., **Sun, Y.**, Wang, C.-J., & Liu, X. F. (2025). The Dark Side of the Internet: Fueling Misinformation in the COVID-19 Pandemic and the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election. *Communication and the Public, 11*(2), 160–181.

[1] **Sun, Y.**, Yan, X.-F., Zhang, Y., Chen, J., Chen, Z., & Wang, C.-J. (2024). Globalization in International Tensions: The Impact of Military Conflicts on the Cultural Orientations of Multinational Corporations' Advertising in Modern China (1932–1937). *Chinese Journal of Communication, 17*(4), 452–470.

UNDER REVIEW

[9] **Sun, Y.**, & Ma, Z. (Revise & Resubmit). Bipolarity of Positive and Negative Affects: Contemporaneous Network Relations of Nuanced Affect States. *Cognition and Emotion*.

[8] **Sun, Y.**, & Ma, Z. (Revise & Resubmit). Inside Right-Wing Authoritarianism: Item-Level Dynamics with COVID-19 Fear and Prevention Beliefs. *British Journal of Social Psychology*.

[7] **Sun, Y.**, & Markowitz, D. M. (Under Review). How Conspiratorial Predispositions Amplify Winner–Loser Polarization in Perceived Electoral Legitimacy.

[6] **Sun, Y.**, Markowitz, D. M., & Bailenson, J. N. (Under Review). A Guide for Studying Language Use in Virtual and Augmented Reality. In A. Atay & D. L. Fassett (Eds.), *Communication and Education With AI*. Cognella Academic Publishing.

[5] **Sun, Y.**, Markowitz, D. M., Zhang, Y., & Wang, C.-J. (Under Review). Behind the Roles We Play: How U.S. Politicians' Social Media Narrative Identity Relates to Their Dissent Voting Behavior.

[4] **Sun, Y.**, & Ma, Z. (Under Review). Phenomenal Consciousness in Females and Access Consciousness in Males Are More Closely Associated with Emotions.

[3] Zhang, Y., **Sun, Y.**, & Wang, C.-J. (Under Review). Narrative Road to Fame: The Roles of Online Interaction, Network Structure, and Narrative Identity in Shaping Cross-Platform Popularity of U.S. Senators (2015–2025).

[2] Zhang, Y., **Sun, Y.**, Yan, L., Yan, X. F., & Wang, C.-J. (Under Review). Is National Identity Harmless to Ingroup Members? Leveraging Ingroup Favoritism and Moral Foundation to Promote Online Fandom Donation.

[1] Zhang, Y., Xiao, X., **Sun, Y.**, & Wang, C.-J. (Under Review). Who Leads the Framing of Grassroots Sports on Social Media? Frame and Emotional Activation Across Government, Media, and Public Actors.

SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

[6] **Sun, Y.**, Markowitz, D. M., & Eden, A. L. Character Arcs: Measuring Protagonist Agency Trajectories and Their Differential Effects on Narrative Success.

[5] **Sun, Y.**, & Markowitz, D. M. Text Analysis of Social Media Content. In M. A. Hamilton (Ed.), *Handbook of Research Methods in Communication Studies*. Edward Elgar Publishing Ltd.

[4] **Sun, Y.**, Zhang, J., & Markowitz, D. M. Softening the Blow? Euphemistic Framing in Disaster Warnings Attenuates Threat Perception and Protective Action Intention.

[3] **Sun, Y.**, Zhang, X. & Markowitz, D. M. Asymmetrical Reciprocity in Human–LLM Relationships: Resource Exchange, Attachment, and Dependence.

[2] Song, M., **Sun, Y.** Gendered Self-Presentation in Campaign Biographies and Electoral Success in U.S. House Elections.

[1] Wang, Y., **Sun, Y.**, Tamborini, R. Sensation Seeking Dictionary (SSD): Developing A Theory-Driven NLP Tool for Communication Research.

PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

[10] **Sun, Y.** (2026, November). Behind the Roles We Play: How U.S. Politicians' Social Media Narrative Identity Relates to Their Dissent Voting Behavior. Paper presented at the *National Communication Association (NCA) 112th Annual Convention*, New Orleans, LA.

[9] Wang, Y., **Sun, Y.**, Tamborini, R., Cabadas, I., & McCollom, L. (2026, September). Sensation Seeking Dictionary (SSD): Developing A Theory-Driven NLP Tool for Communication Research. Poster presented at the *Communication Science Futures 2026 Conference*, East Lansing, MI.

[8] **Sun, Y.**, & Ma, Z. (2025, November). Bipolarity of Positive and Negative Affects: Contemporaneous Network Relations of Nuanced Affect States. Paper presented at the *National Communication Association (NCA) 111th Annual Convention*, Denver, CO.

[7] Li, W., **Sun, Y.**, & Yue, Y. (2025, November). Artificial Intelligence vs. Medical Experts: A Comparative Analysis of Semantic Quality and Readability in Health Advice from Large Language Models and Human Institutions. Paper presented at the *National Communication Association (NCA) 111th Annual Convention*, Denver, CO.

[6] **Sun, Y.**, & Ma, Z. (2024, November). Authoritarians in Response to Societal Crises: Reciprocal Dynamics of Right-Wing Authoritarianism, COVID-19 Fear and Prevention Belief. Paper presented at the *National Communication Association (NCA) 110th Annual Convention*, New Orleans, LA. [**Top Paper Award**]

[5] **Sun, Y.**, Fei, Y., & Yu, C. (2024, November). Resource Exchange, Perceived Social Support, Companionship and Intimacy: Characterizing the Social Relationship Between Users and ChatGPT. Paper presented at the *National Communication Association (NCA) 110th Annual Convention*, New Orleans, LA. [**Top Student Paper Award**]

[4] **Sun, Y.** (2024, November). Building Identity Through Narratives: Who Voices Dissent Within the Party?. Paper presented at the *National Communication Association (NCA) 110th Annual Convention*, New Orleans, LA.

[3] Zhang, Y., **Sun, Y.**, Chen, Z., & Wang, C.-J. (2024, November). How Emotion and Narrative Foster Resilience in Adversity: The Case of Large-Scale Online Donations during COVID-19. Paper presented at the *National Communication Association (NCA) 110th Annual Convention*, New Orleans, LA.

[2] **Sun, Y.**, Yan, X.-F., Zhang, Y., Chen, Z., & Wang, C.-J. (2023, May). From Imperialism to Cultural Imperialism: Localized Versus Globalized Advertisements of Imported Commodities in China (1932–1937). Paper presented at the *73rd Annual International Communication Association (ICA) Conference*, Toronto, Canada.

[1] Zhang, Y., Lu, G., **Sun, Y.**, Chen, Z., & Wang, C.-J. (2023, May). Traversing the Valley of Despair in Affective Mobilization: Issue Engagement, Emotion, and Online Donation on Sina Weibo During the Outbreak of the COVID-19 Pandemic. Paper presented at the *73rd Annual International Communication Association (ICA) Conference*, Toronto, Canada.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

HRCC Lions Research Team, Michigan State University — East Lansing, MI
Student Affiliate — Sep 2026–

Computation & Communication Lab, Michigan State University — East Lansing, MI
Student Member — Aug 2025–

Computational Communication Collaboratory, Nanjing University — Nanjing, China

Student Member / Student Affiliate — Sep 2021–

Chongqing Overseas Publicity Research Center — Chongqing, China
Global Public Opinion Research Intern — May 2020–May 2022

SELECTED HONORS and AWARDS

Research and Academic Excellence

- Top Paper Award — Jul 2024
  Political Communication Division, National Communication Association (NCA)
- Top Student Paper Award — Jul 2024
  Human Communication and Technology Division, National Communication Association (NCA)
- Chongqing Excellent Graduation Thesis Award — Jan 2023

Competitive External Scholarships and Fellowships

- National Scholarship for Graduate Students, ¥20,000 — Oct 2024
- HUANG Jianliang Scholarship, ¥5,000 — Oct 2023
- National Scholarship for Undergraduate Students, ¥8,000 — Dec 2021

Competition Awards

- National Second Place, *Dissemination Data Mining Competition* — Sep 2023
- First Place in West China, *ESG National College Innovation Competition* — Dec 2021
- Provincial Second Prize, *Challenge Cup National Academic Works Competition* — Aug 2021
- Provincial Third Prize, *National Advertising Art Competition* — Jul 2021
- National Third Prize, *National English Competition for College Students* — Nov 2020

Graduation Honors

- Chongqing Distinguished Honor Graduate Award — Jun 2022

GRANTS

External

- National Social Science Foundation of China (22BXW032), ¥200,000, *Research Fellow* — 2022–2025
  Project title: *Computational Narrative Research on Chinese Stories and Chinese Voices in the Digital Media Era* (PI: Cheng-Jun Wang)
- CAST Science Popularization Program (KXYJS2022063), ¥30,000, *co-PI* — 2022–2024
  Project title: *The Dissemination of Science Popularizating Information in Public Health Emergencies and Its Impact on Social Mobilization* (co-PI: Yaotian Zhang)

- Chongqing College Students' Innovation Training Program (S202010650015), ¥2,500, *PI* 2020–2021
  Project title: *Research on the Visualization of Public Opinions along the Belt and Road from the Perspective of Geopolitics: Twitter as an Example*

Internal

- Distinguished Postgraduate Talent Cultivation Program (2023GYB08), ¥10,000, *PI* 2023–2025
  Project title: *Research on Advertising Strategies for Imported Commodities during the Republic of China from the Perspective of Cultural Imperialism*

Travel Grants

- Graduate Office Fellowship (GOF), $2,250 2026
- Graduate Office Fellowship (GOF), $2,000 2025
- National Communication Association (NCA) Student Caucus Travel Grant, $200 2024

TEACHING

Primary Instructor

COM 100: Human Communication, Michigan State University Summer 2026
Undergraduate lecture

Teaching Assistant

COM 100: Human Communication, Michigan State University Spring 2027
Undergraduate lecture; Instructor: Allison L. Eden

COM 100: Human Communication, Michigan State University Fall 2025, Spring 2026, Fall 2026
Undergraduate lecture; Instructor: Dustin M. Carnahan

Applications of Large Language Models in Digital Humanities, Nanjing University Spring 2025
Undergraduate lecture; Instructor: Zhihao Ma

Text Data Analysis, Nanjing University Spring 2024
Graduate lecture; Instructor: Zhicong Chen

Planning and Creative Strategy, Nanjing University Spring 2024
Graduate seminar; Instructor: Zhihao Ma

Advertising Strategy and Creation, Nanjing University Fall 2023, Fall 2024
Undergraduate lecture; Instructor: Zhihao Ma

ACADEMIC SERVICES

Service to Universities and Departments

Michigan State University

Undergraduate Affairs Committee Sep 2026–Aug 2027
— Advise the Department of Communication on issues pertaining to undergraduate programs.

Dean's Advisory Committee Sep 2025–Aug 2026
— Advise the dean on matters of the College of Communication Arts and Sciences.

Service to Academic Associations

National Communication Association (NCA)

Graduate Student/IDEA Representative, *Communication Anxiety and Apprehension Division* Jan 2026–Dec 2026
— Represent graduate student members, promote IDEA initiatives, manage division social media, and facilitate communication between the division and graduate student community.

Information Officer, *Human Communication and Technology Division* Jan 2025–Dec 2026
— Manage division communications and oversee social media engagement.

Service to Academic Media Platforms

Data Visualization Editor, *Fact-Checking Records* Oct 2022–Jan 2024
— Edit data-driven news content, including topic development, research, writing, data analysis, and visual design.

Editor, *Computational Communication Academy* Sep 2022–Aug 2023
— Compile and disseminate computational social science research; author newsletters highlighting developments from the Computational Communication Collaboratory.

Ad Hoc Reviewer for Academic Journals

Computers in Human Behavior Reports 2025
Cyberpsychology, Behavior, and Social Networking 2026
New Ideas in Psychology 2025

SKILLS

- **Statistical Programming / Markup Languages:** Python, R, Stata, LaTeX, HTML, SQL, CSS, SPSS
- **Applications:** Tableau, Gephi, Brackets, Photoshop, Premier Pro, Animate, Audition
- **Languages:** Mandarin (Native), English (Proficient), Japanese (Elementary)
- **Music:** Piano (Level 8 Certificate), Singing